

East meets West

Dalai Lama joined Twitter on February 22nd with over 50k plus followers in a day.

GeForce GTX 480 / 470

Nvidia officially announced the dates for launch of the GeForce GTX 470 / 480 at March 26, 2010

features like the smart ringer sensor. The phone hides a G-sensor which on detecting that a phone has been picked up, reduces the ringer volume.

The Friendstream window gets all your contacts' Twitter, Facebook streams on one platform, very similar to the Sense UI. With Friendstream you don't have to go the contacts page to access the integrated contacts.

Leap is an application that allows you to get a thumbnail sized versions of your home screens which is also a great addition as it saves time.

HTC Legend is expected to hit the markets in April 2010.

Windows Mobile

One of the most talked about launches at MWC was the much awaited Windows 7 Mobile.

The new operating system dubbed Windows Phone 7 Series comes after several lackluster offerings from Microsoft in previous version including Win Mo 6. All eyes

are naturally focused on this new avatar especially since Android is rapidly gaining popularity. Since the time Apple set a benchmark in how OSes for phones should be designed, many of Win Mo's earlier versions came under a lot of criticism for being ill designed. The start menu for instance was exactly like the one found on the PC version ie. in the form of a list, making it extremely cumbersome for touch input. "Phones looked like PCs, but a phone is not a PC, it's smaller, more personal," Joe Belfiore, vice president for Windows Phone is reported to have said at the launch. No kidding! Still, better late than never. This time around Windows has designed the OS to more suit the touch interface with large 'tiles' making up the quick launch screen. These connect the user to the most used elements in the phone, be it favourite apps, websites or even links to Facebook profiles.

The tiles are dynamic or live, so they change when the underlying content changes. Overall the interface is quite a shift from any of the previous flavours of the OS, and more closely resembles the Zune HD player. Instead of going by individual applications for performing a set of functions, the OS makes use of Hubs which are basically like activity centers. The people Hub lets you access all your social networking functions in a single place. You have three distinct streams — recent, all and what's new. Recent shows the most recent changes your friends have made to their profile, all is the general news



The new quick launch screen for Win Mo 7

feed, while what's new is the aggregation of status updates. Similarly, the Pictures Hub aggregates pictures while the Office Hub takes care of your productivity needs. Under the office Hub you have OneNote, Documents and Sharepoint.

In a rather surprising move Microsoft has locked customisation of the OS by hardware manufacturers. HTC for instance earlier replaced the UI shell with their own version called TouchFlo found on phones like HTC Touch 2. It's doubtful whether anyone will miss it. Ms has even fixed hardware requirements from their hardware partners. These specifications include capacitive touchscreens and a fixed set of hardware buttons for Home, Search and Back. This should work well with the developer community since as much as users appreciate flexibility, app developers wouldn't mind

knowing that certain hardware features will always be present when coding software. This is a major gripe with Android. In any case, we'll know how users react once the first of these phones start rolling out end of this year.

MeeGo – Is it a me too?

Finnish mobile phone giant Nokia did not have any phone launches this year which surprised quite a lot of tech enthusiasts. But, Nokia made its presence felt in the MWC in the form of a collaboration with processor manufacturing behemoth Intel, where they announced plans to merge their mobile operating systems into MeeGo.

MeeGo, a Linux based open OS is targeted at everything from cellphones to set top boxes. "MeeGo blends the very best of Moblin and Maemo software into one Linux based

computing platform.

MeeGo will be targetting a wide range of devices including popular mobile computing devices as

well as netbooks, tablets, connected TVs, media phones and in-vehicle infotainment," said Renee James, SVP Software and Services, Intel Group.

Now it wasn't really clear as to why Nokia and Intel are collaborating on an operating system, which is not the strong point of either companies. The concept sounds promising, but whether it will deliver or not can only be confirmed once we get to use this OS. Like Win Mo 7, it is expected to be used in digital devices by the year end. **d**



HTC Legend

